



BlackBerry's “Productivity Edge” lives on – as an open-source, from-scratch build for any Android phone. This guide shows what the panel does and how to set it up.

Version 0.78 · GNU GPLv3 · no BlackBerry code, only open Android interfaces

Source & APK: github.com/8818freak/EdgeTab

All screenshots are from real use – personal names and content have been redacted.

1 What is EdgeTab?

A slim, tapering handle sits at the screen edge (left or right) – like the original. Tapping or pulling opens a panel of cards: calendar, inbox, contacts, tasks, notes, app widgets, shortcuts and media control, without leaving the current app. **EdgeTab** rebuilds this from scratch – only public, documented Android interfaces (notification access, calendar/contacts providers, AppWidgetHost, MediaSessionManager, JTX Board for tasks).

Free, open source (GNU GPLv3), no ads, no analytics. Runs in German and English (following the device language) and on any Android device from version 10 – no BlackBerry device needed.

2 The edge handle

Tap or pull to open the panel; swipe back or tap outside to close it. Height, vertical position, width and transparency of the panel are all adjustable.

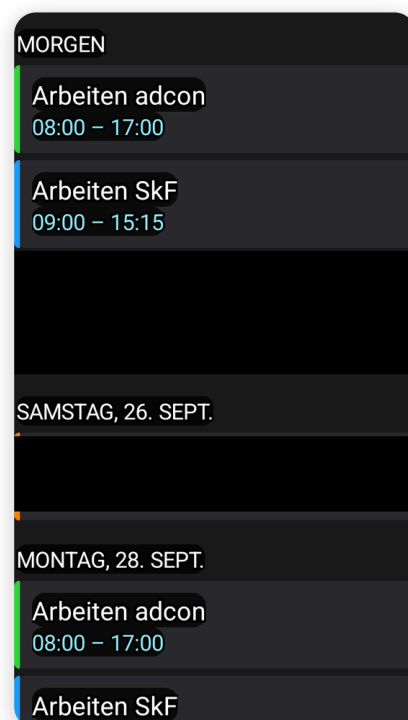
3 Settings & managing cards

The settings tab sits at the top of the card column and is split into short sections (Position & appearance, Header, Inbox, Cards, Service, About). Changes take effect immediately, without a restart. Every card can be toggled, renamed, given its own icon (gallery or bundled) and moved with ▲▼. You can create any number of Widget, Shortcuts, Media and Active-Frames cards.

4 The cards

Calendar

The next 7 days, grouped by day; tap opens the event, the floating button opens the installed calendar app's own “new event” screen.



Calendar card

Inbox

Reads intercepted notifications from chosen source apps (works well with BlackBerry Hub, Telegram, Signal ...), grouped by day. Reply (via the notification's own action, with or without inline text entry) and delete both trigger the real action in the source app. Categories colour and filter the inbox.



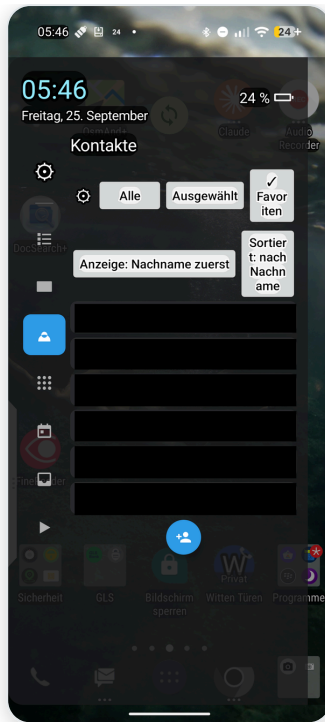
Inbox with categories



Sources & categories

Contacts

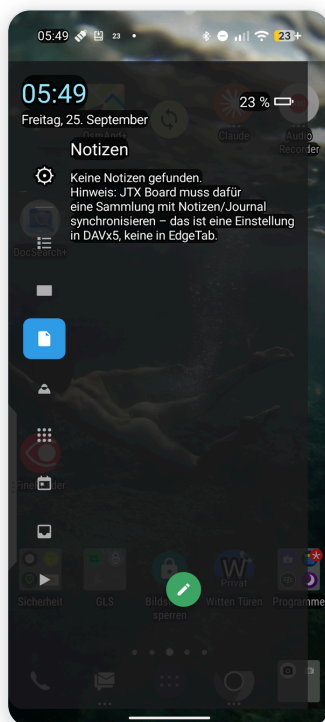
All contacts, a hand-picked subset or favourites only; name display and sort order are independently adjustable.



Contacts card

Tasks & notes

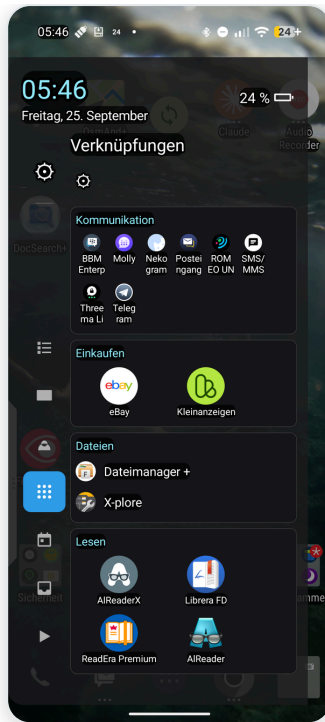
Tasks are read (and can be checked off) from **JTX Board**, which itself syncs via DAVx⁵/CalDAV with any server. The note button hands new notes to ImapNotes3.



Notes card

Shortcuts, widgets & media control

Shortcuts are a pure app launcher – sortable into freely named groups, grid or list per group. Widget cards embed any installed app widget (e.g. the real Hub inbox widget). Media control shows and controls active playback, with fixed-position quick buttons (top/middle/bottom).



Shortcuts, grouped

Active Frames (Widget 2)

A native “Active Frames” card: your recently used apps as scrollable tiles, with a red star and the app image/logo. It pulls its data from the **Active Frames** app over a secured channel – EdgeTab needs no extra permissions. Because the panel draws the tiles itself, the card scrolls reliably.

5 Crash safety & error log

If EdgeTab crashes, the service restarts automatically (so the edge bar doesn't just vanish). The error message is saved to a log and shown under “About EdgeTab” – only if a crash actually happened, with a clear button.

◀ Zurück Über EdgeTab

EdgeTab 0.72

Eine von Grund auf neu geschriebene
Nachbildung von BlackBerrys
„Productivity Edge – eine aufziehbare
Randleiste mit frei konfigurierbaren
Karten. Kein BlackBerry-Code, nur
offene Android-Schnittstellen.

About EdgeTab (version, licence, log)

6 Backup & restore

Under “Service” you can back up and restore all settings and cards (order, names, icons, widget/shortcut assignments) as a file – via the system file dialog, without storage permission.